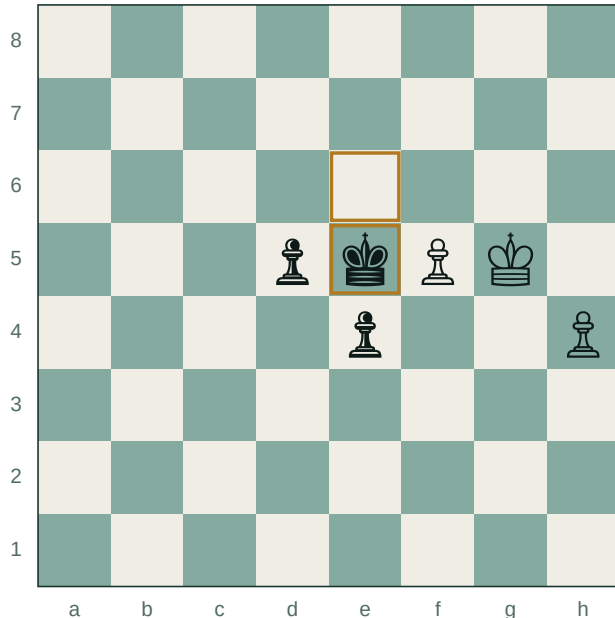


# Pawn-ending calculation: White, move 48

Pawn-ending calculation

White to move



Previous move: 47...Ke5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 48. f6 Ke6 49. Kg6

**48.f6** The pawn moves from f5 to f6. Recorded reply: **48...Ke6**.

**49.Kg6** The king moves from g5 to g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not enter a pawn ending because it looks simple. Rook-pawn exceptions and zugzwang can make a material advantage irrelevant.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

With only kings and pawns, a single tempo can reverse the result. Calculate opposition, capture routes, promotion races, and reserve pawn moves precisely.

### HOW TO LOOK

Count actual king moves and pawn pushes, then include whose turn it is and whether promotion gives check.

The defending king is on e5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.